UX CASE STUDY

Zomato — Food Discovery & Delivery Experience

Objective	Analyze the end-to-end user journey, identify UX strengths and pain points, and propose three practical improvements.
Scope	Consumer mobile-app journey: discovery → restaurant selection → checkout → delivery → support.
Method	Heuristic review of the core journey, review of public product information, and synthesis of recent user-review themes.

Executive Summary

Zomato is a mature food-delivery and discovery platform with a large restaurant network and a broad set of features. Its strongest UX qualities are discoverability, rich restaurant information, personalization, and a familiar ordering flow. The main opportunity is not adding more features; it is making failure states—especially payment uncertainty, delivery delays, cancellation/refund questions, and support escalation—more transparent and recoverable.

Key finding

The experience is strongest when everything goes as planned, but trust drops sharply when an order enters an unexpected state. The redesign therefore focuses on transparency, control, and fast recovery.

Current product context

Zomato currently describes its platform as operating across 800+ cities with 300,000+ restaurants and 3 billion+ orders delivered. Its app also supports discovery and ordering features such as Healthy Mode, Veg Mode, collections, scheduled orders, offers and more. ■cite-style■

The Google Play listing showed a 4.7/5 rating from about 14.1 million reviews in September 2026. Recent public reviews also contain complaints about unclear payment outcomes, delivery delays, cancellations and difficulty getting satisfactory support. These reviews are individual experiences rather than proof that every user encounters the same problem.

1. User Journey Analysis

Stage	User goal	Typical actions	UX assessment
1. Discover	Find suitable food	Open app, set location, search cuisine/dish, browse recommendations	Strong discovery, but many choices can increase decision effort.
2. Evaluate	Choose a restaurant	Compare rating, delivery time, price, offers, menu and reviews	Rich information supports decisions; ranking/filtering is critical.
3. Select	Build the order	Open menu, customize items, add to cart	Familiar interaction pattern; price/offer details must remain clear.
4. Checkout	Pay with confidence	Confirm address, review bill, select payment, place order	High-trust moment; payment failure needs explicit status.
5. Track	Know when food arrives	View order status, ETA and delivery progress	Tracking is useful, but stale ETA can create frustration.
6. Resolve	Fix problems if needed	Contact support, cancel, request refund, rate order	Most important recovery stage; speed and human escalation matt

Journey map

DISCOVER	EVALUATE	CHECKOUT	TRACK	RECOVER
Search / feed	Restaurant + menu	Payment + confirmation	ETA + live status	Support / refund
■	■	■	■ / ■	■

Critical UX moments: checkout confirmation, changing ETAs, order cancellation, payment/refund status, and access to support.

2. Strengths & Weaknesses

Strength	Why it works
Strong discovery	Search, categories, collections and personalized ranking reduce the effort of finding restaurants.
Information-rich listings	Ratings, reviews, menus, delivery information and offers support informed decisions.
Feature breadth	The product supports delivery plus adjacent use cases such as scheduled ordering and Healthy Mode.
Familiar interaction patterns	Search → list → restaurant → cart → checkout is easy to learn for returning users.
Personalization	Zomato has described using browsing and order history to personalize restaurant ranking.

Weakness / risk	UX impact
Payment uncertainty	If a payment appears to fail while the order is actually created, users may reorder and face duplicate-order or ref
ETA reliability	A repeatedly changing or stale ETA reduces trust in the tracking experience.
Support friction	Users can struggle to reach a satisfactory resolution for delayed, cancelled or disputed orders.
Choice overload	Large inventories and many offers can make quick decisions harder, especially for users who already know roug
Recovery is less visible than ordering	The happy path is prominent; exception handling should be equally clear and actionable.

Evidence note

Recent Google Play and App Store reviews include reports of payment ambiguity, delayed delivery, cancellation/refund difficulty and unsatisfactory support. These are qualitative signals used to identify UX risks, not statistically representative user research.

3. Proposed UX Improvements

Improvement 1 — Clear payment & order confirmation

Introduce a dedicated transaction-state screen that distinguishes **Payment processing**, **Order confirmed**, **Payment failed**, and **Refund initiated**. Add a single primary next action so users do not feel forced to place another order.

Improvement 2 — Honest, proactive delivery ETA

Replace a single countdown with an ETA range plus confidence/context. If the system detects a significant delay, show the reason, updated range and available options before the user has to contact support.

Improvement 3 — Faster support escalation

Create an order-specific support hub with issue categories, automated status checks, refund/cancellation eligibility, and a visible escalation path when automated help cannot resolve the problem.

Design principles behind the redesign

Principle	Application
Visibility of system status	Always show whether payment, order, delivery or refund is pending, successful or failed.
User control	Give clear actions such as retry payment, wait safely, cancel if eligible, or contact support.
Error prevention	Warn users before creating a duplicate order when a previous payment/order state is unresolved.
Consistency	Use the same status language and icons across checkout, tracking and support.
Trust & transparency	Explain delays and financial outcomes in plain language instead of hiding them behind generic messages.

4. Sample Sketches / Mockups

The following are conceptual redesign sketches created for this case study; they are not screenshots of Zomato's current interface.

A. Payment State		C. Order Support Hub
✓ ORDER STATUS: Payment processing	DELIVERY UPDATE	HELP WITH THIS ORDER
Your order has not been duplicated.	New ETA: 8:20–8:35 PM	What do you need help with?
Amount: ■428 • Restaurant: Example Kitchen	Reason: Restaurant preparation is taking longer.	• Payment / charged but not confirmed
Estimated confirmation: within 30 seconds	✓ Order accepted ✓ Preparing • Delivery delayed	• Order delayed
[View order status]	[Notify me when rider is assigned]	• Missing / incorrect item
[Contact support]	[Get help]	• Cancel / refund
If payment fails: [Retry payment]		Issue status: No active request
		[Talk to support]

Expected UX impact

Improvement	Primary metric	Expected direction
Payment state	Duplicate-order / payment-support contacts	↓
Delay-aware tracking	ETA-related complaints and cancellations	↓
Support hub	Time to resolution / repeat contacts	↓

Conclusion

Zomato's core journey is effective because it combines strong discovery with a familiar ordering model. The largest UX opportunity is to strengthen the experience when things go wrong. A more explicit transaction state, honest ETA communication, and a structured support escalation path would improve user confidence without adding unnecessary complexity.

Sources: Zomato official website and product posts; Google Play listing and public reviews; Apple App Store public reviews. Accessed October 2026.